آغا خان یونیورسٹی ایگزامینیشن بورڈ

AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

Notes from E-Marking Centre on HSSC-I Principles of Commerce Annual Examinations 2025

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC) Part I Principles of Commerce. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2025 HSSC-I Examination indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on candidates' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of candidates' responses that support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that requires candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used. It is imperative to refer to the command word guide available on AKU-EB website for understanding the expectations of the command word

General Observations

The overall performance of candidates in Principles of Commerce was satisfactory, with the majority demonstrate a clear understanding of fundamental concepts and the ability to apply the principles in the context of Commerce. However, a notable variation in performance was observed across the paper.

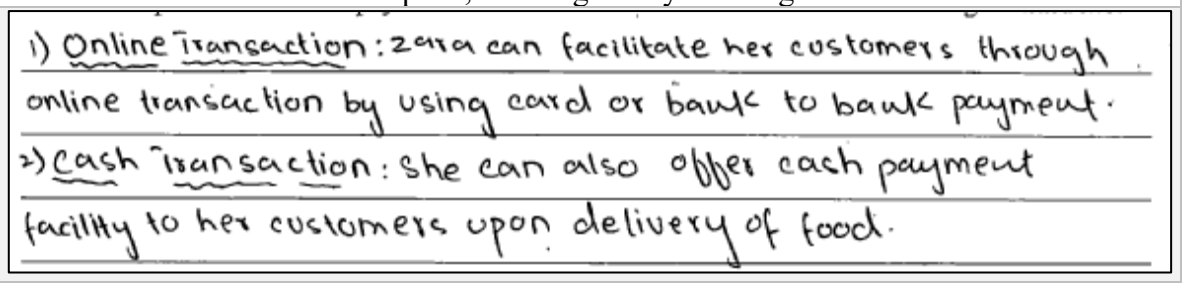
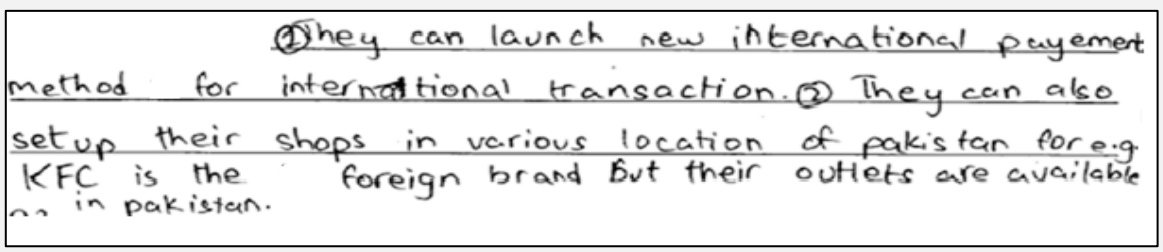
Candidates performed well in topics related to possible modes of payment, qualities as a business owner, objectives for organising the meetings of Joint Stock Company, suitability of sole proprietorship form of business for South Asian countries., indexing or filing system, channel of distribution and mode of Islamic finance.

Candidates faced challenges in topics related to product life cycle, overcome communication barriers, form of business activities and letter drafting.

Note: Candidates' responses shown in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format, or information.

DETAILED COMMENTS

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

Question No. 1	
Question Text	Zara Foods is a small-scale enterprise that provides food supplies to domestic and small-scale commercial clients. The business uses social media platforms such as Facebook, Twitter and WhatsApp for its operations. What TWO possible modes of payment can it offer to customers in Pakistan for making transactions?
SLO No.	1.4.7
SLO Text	Explain the modes of the electronic payment i.e. credit card, debit card, smart card, e-money, electronic fund transfer (EFT) and e-banking.
Max Marks	2
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each source of finance (TWO required).
Overall Performance	The majority of the candidates scored full marks in this question. Only a small number was unable to attempt it due to lack of knowledge. Overall, this question was relatively easy, and most candidates were able to handle it well. The performance indicates that candidates have a good understanding of basic transaction methods in a business context and are familiar with distinguishing between cash and online payments.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* demonstrated a clear and accurate understanding of the question. Candidates correctly included both online and cash transaction methods in their answers. Many elaborated on online payment modes with relevant examples such as EFT (Electronic Fund Transfers), debit and credit card payments, and mobile applications like JazzCash and EasyPaisa and cash on delivery (COD). The answers were well-organised, addressed all aspects of the question, and reflected both conceptual knowledge and practical understanding. These candidates successfully linked the payment methods to the operations of a small-scale domestic enterprise, showing clarity of thought and attention to detail.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* often failed to align with the question's requirements. Some candidates described international payment methods, which were irrelevant because the case study referred to Zara Food, a small-scale domestic enterprise. Others discussed ideas such as opening additional outlets, which had no connection with transaction methods. These responses indicated a misunderstanding of the context and a lack of focus on the command words. In many cases, the candidates provided incomplete or off-topic answers, which led to lower marks.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

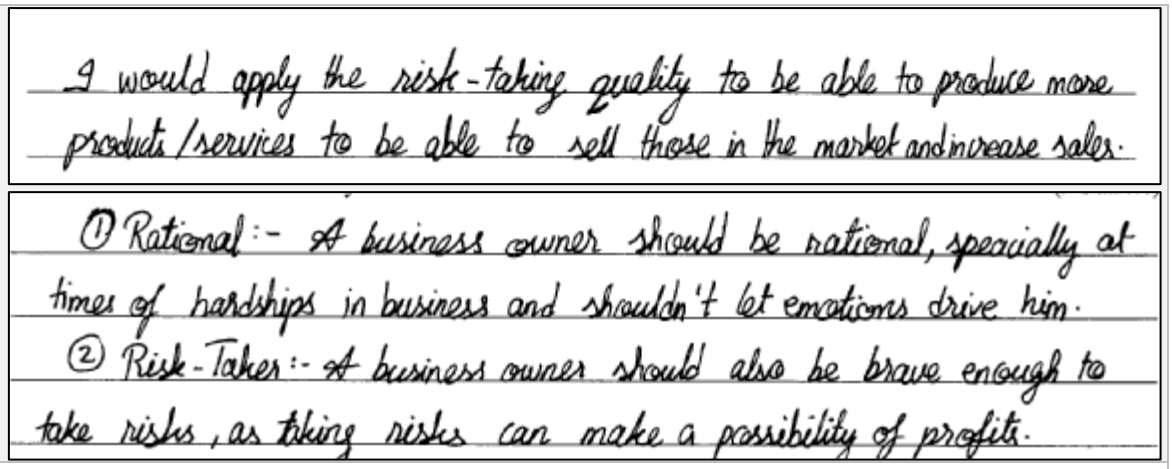
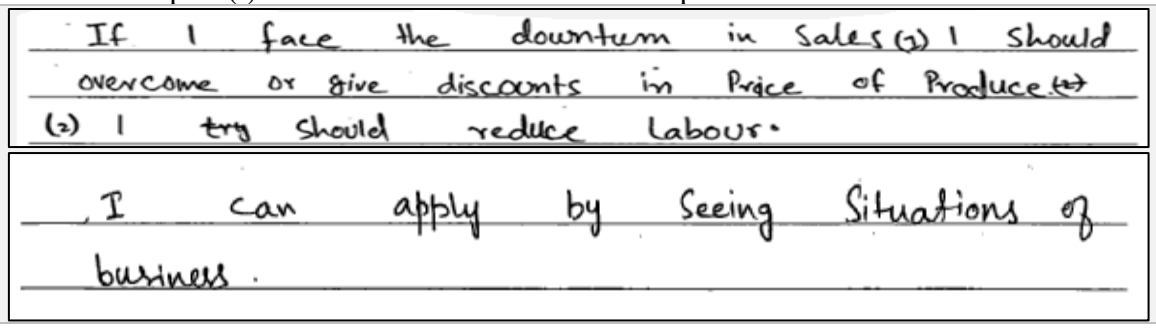
Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy** Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Practical Demonstration ** For description of each Pedagogy, refer to Annexure A	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Encourage practice with questions that distinguish between domestic and international transactions.
- Reinforce the concept of online payment methods, including practical examples from local businesses.
- Provide exercises where candidates differentiate cash vs. online payments with examples, to ensure clarity in understanding.

*K = Knowledge U = Understanding A = Application and other higher-order cognitive skills

Question No. 2	
Question Text	Imagine you are a business owner facing a sudden downturn in sales. Mention any TWO qualities as a business owner do you think are essential for you to navigate this situation successfully. How would you apply any ONE of the qualities mentioned in part (i) to turn things around?
SLO No.	Elaborate the qualities of a good businessman.
SLO Text	1.3.4
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each quality as a business owner source of finance (TWO required). Give ONE mark for applying the qualities.
Overall Performance	In this question, most candidates were able to clearly mention two qualities of a businessman in part (i). In part (ii), they applied one of the qualities mentioned earlier and explained how it could help turn the situation in their favour. Overall, candidates performed well, showing an understanding of the concept and the ability to relate theoretical knowledge to a practical scenario.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* directly followed the demand of the question. Candidates accurately listed two relevant qualities of a businessman in part (i), such as decision-making ability, risk-taking, honesty, or leadership. In part (ii), they selected one of these qualities and provided a clear explanation of how it could be applied to the given scenario, like Effective communication with my team and stakeholders. Strategic thinking helps in long-term planning, demonstrating logical reasoning and practical application. Their answers were structured, relevant, and showed a strong grasp of both conceptual knowledge and scenario-based analysis.

Images of Better Responses	
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* revealed a misunderstanding of the question. Some candidates wrote about general strategies to overcome the problem in the scenario, such as extension strategies to save a product from decline, instead of focusing on the qualities of a businessman. In part (ii), many candidates failed to apply even a single quality which discussed in part (i) that's made their answers incomplete.
Images of Weaker Responses	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion:

- Use comparative charts on the board showing examples of qualities (e.g., honesty, confidence, creativity) and strategies (e.g., setting goals, delegating tasks, using incentives).
- Present real-life business or classroom situations and ask students to respond as if they were decision-makers.
- Display a "business word wall" in the classroom with key terms (e.g., leadership, motivation, innovation, planning).

Question No. 3

Question Text

Explain any TWO objectives for organising the following meetings by a Joint Stock Company.

S. No.	Type of Shareholder Meetings	Objectives
1.	Statutory meeting	
2.	Annual general body meeting (AGM)	
3.	Extra-ordinary general meetings (EoGM)	

SLO No.	2.12.2
SLO Text	Discuss the following types of shareholder's meetings with reference to their objectives and characteristics: * a. statutory meeting b. annual general body meeting (AGM) c. extra-ordinary general meetings (EoGM).
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each two objectives of the meeting in the given grid. Give ONE mark if the student mentioned one objective of each meeting instead of writing two objectives.
Overall Performance	The overall performance in this question was satisfactory. A good number of candidates were able to correctly identify the objectives of the different types of shareholders' meetings. However, some candidates lost marks by confusing the timeline of meetings with their objectives, which revealed that while they had a general awareness of the topic, they did not fully grasp the exact requirement of the question.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* correctly identified the objectives of all three types of shareholders' meetings. Candidates explained that the statutory meeting is mainly held to win the confidence of shareholders and to discuss the company's details and future goals with them. For the Annual General Meeting (AGM) they mentioned that it is primarily focused on reviewing and discussing the financial report of the company. Lastly, they mentioned that the Extraordinary General Meeting (EOGM) is called for urgent matters that cannot be delayed until the next AGM. These responses were clear, accurate, and directly connected to the demand of the question.

Image of Better Response

S. No.	Type of Shareholder Meetings	Objectives
1.	Statutory meeting	→ Statutory meeting is held bw shareholdes to inform them how business is operating in it's early stages. In this meeting shareholders discuss objective, purpose and pln make primlary decision. It is held once in company's life.
2.	Annual general body meeting (AGM)	→ It is held bw shareholders to discuss financial reports and accounts. → In this meeting directors are elected. → It is held once a year.
3.	Extra-ordinary general meetings (EoGM)	→ It is called to ~~discuss urgent~~ make urgent dise decision. It can't be delayed. → To discuss change in policies, legal problems ~~and~~ → It can be called any time.

Description of Weaker Responses

Weaker responses revealed that some candidates misunderstood the question and confused the purpose of the meetings with the time when they are conducted. Instead of describing the objectives, they explained details such as when statutory meetings or AGMs are supposed to be held, which was not asked. In addition, a few candidates repeated the same objective for all types of meetings, showing lack of understanding of their differences. Such responses not only missed the key point of the question.

Image of Weaker Response

S. No.	Type of Shareholder Meetings	Objectives
1.	Statutory meeting	
2.	Annual general body meeting (AGM)	Annual General body meeting held one time in a 6 months
3.	Extra-ordinary general meetings (EoGM)	(eogm) will held atleast one time in a Year

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

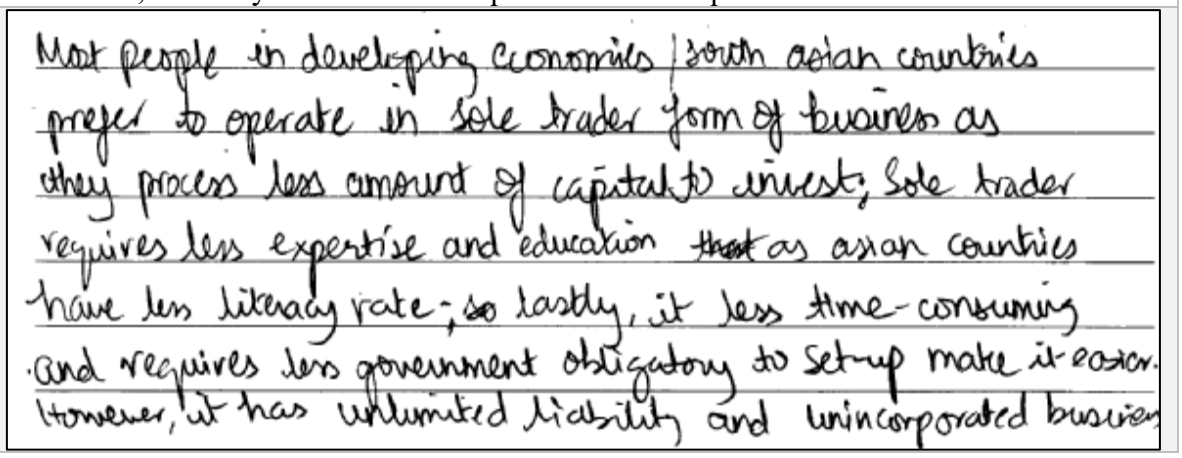
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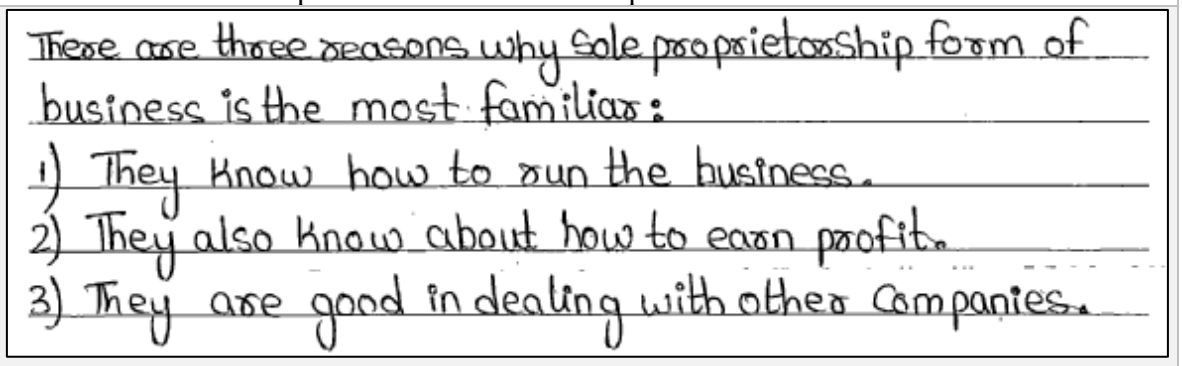
• Utilise the resource guide for additional materials		

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Candidates need guided practice to clearly separate the timeline of meetings from their objectives. This can be reinforced through comparative charts that show when each meeting is held alongside why it is conducted.
- Teachers may focus on application-based teaching, where candidates practice identifying objectives in relation to real-life examples of companies.
- Use of class discussions and role-play of meetings can help strengthen understanding of their purposes.

Question No. 4

Question Text	Why sole proprietorship form of business is the most familiar and commonly opted form of business in South Asian economies. Mention any THREE reasons.
SLO No.	2.2.5
SLO Text	Analyse the suitability of sole proprietorship for South Asian countries.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each reason
Overall Performance	Overall performance in this question most of the candidates were able to score full marks. These candidates correctly identified the reasons for choosing sole proprietorship in South Asian countries and related them to the socio-economic context of the region. However, some candidates confused the requirement of the question with simply writing down the characteristics of sole proprietorship. This showed that while candidates were aware of the general features of this form of business, they did not fully understand that the question required them to explain why people of a particular region prefer it. The weaker performance highlighted the need for candidates to carefully interpret the question and respond to its specific demand.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* clearly explained the reasons for opting for sole proprietorship in South Asian countries and successfully connected these reasons with regional realities. For example, candidates explained that sole proprietorship requires less capital, which makes it more suitable in South Asian countries where there is a shortage of capital. People prefer this form of business because it involves fewer legal formalities. Furthermore, candidates highlighted that sole proprietorship allows greater independence and less government interference, which matches the preference of many individuals in South Asian countries who value autonomy in their business decisions. These responses were well-elaborated, contextual, and fully addressed the requirement of the question.
Image of Better Response	 Most people in developing economies / south asian countries prefer to operate in sole trader form of business as they process less amount of capital to invest; Sole trader requires less expertise and education ~~that~~ as asian countries have less literacy rate; so lastly, it less time-consuming and requires less government obligatory to set-up make it easier. However, it has unlimited liability and unincorporated busines

Description of Weaker Responses	*Weaker responses* often listed random characteristics of sole proprietorship without relating them to the South Asian context. Instead of focusing on the reasons for preference, candidates repeated general points about advantages or disadvantages. For instance, some simply mentioned that a sole proprietorship allows quick decisions or personal control without linking it to the social, cultural, or economic behavior of people in South Asian countries. Such responses lacked application and did not demonstrate the ability to tailor knowledge to the given scenario. This suggested that some candidates had remember content but did not adapt it to the context of the question.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

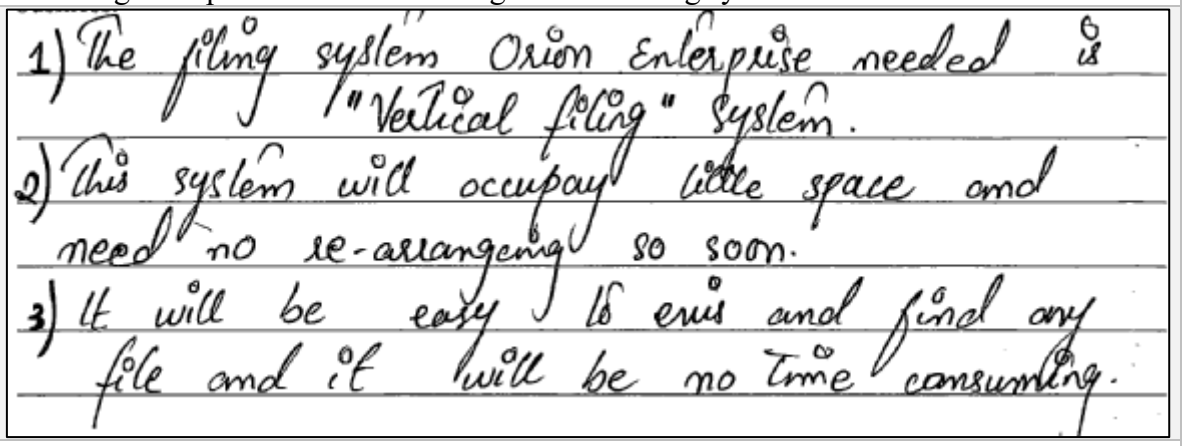
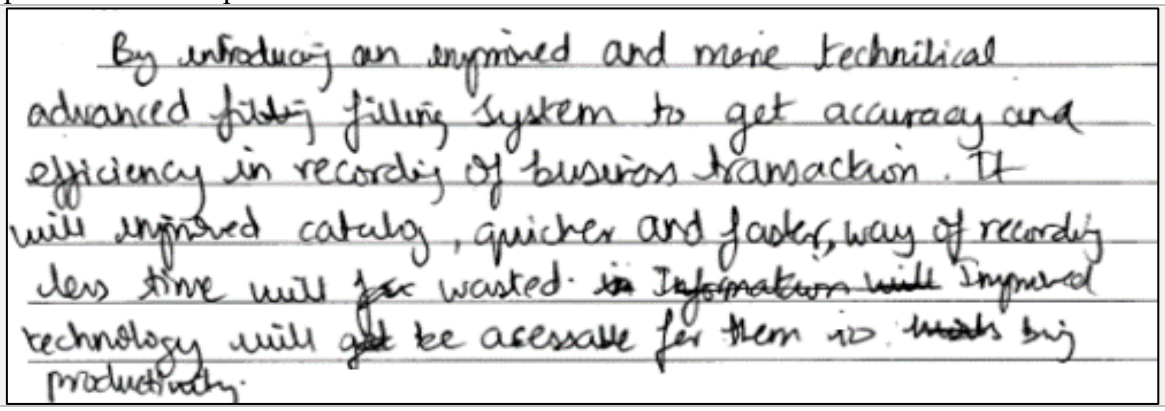
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Any Additional Suggestion:

- Candidates should be trained to differentiate between general features of a business organisation and the specific reasons for its preference in each context.
- Practice with scenario-based past paper questions will help candidates learn to apply knowledge rather than simply recalling facts. (ThinkIB.net, Study.com)
- Encourage candidates to underline or highlight command words to stay focused on what is being asked, particularly in context-driven questions.

Question No. 5

Question Text	Orion Enterprises, a mid-sized accounting firm, has used a filing system for over a decade, stacking files in cabinets. As the firm's document storage needs have grown, employees face numerous challenges of space, organisation and document retrieval. Files are harder to access and the team spends excessive time searching for information. Suggest a suitable alternate filling system and list TWO benefits that the system will bring to the business.
SLO No.	3.2.8

SLO Text	Evaluate determinants for selecting a particular indexing or filing system for different business organisation and departments.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for the suggestion. Give ONE mark for mention merits to selection (TWO required).
Overall Performance	A good number of candidates demonstrated sound knowledge of the topic and secured full marks. They were able to apply their understanding to the given scenario and suggest appropriate alternatives. However, a considerable portion of candidates performacne not up to mark because they failed to connect their responses to the requirements of the question.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* correctly addressed the requirement of the question. Candidates suggested an alternative filing system to the one mentioned in the scenario. For example, when the scenario described a horizontal filing system, they proposed the vertical filing system as an alternative. They clearly explained the benefits, such as saving time in locating files since they are placed next to each other in the cabinet and reducing the chance of file damage. These responses were precise, logically structured, and demonstrated both knowledge and practical understanding of office filing systems.
Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* did not directly identify a suitable filing system nor explained its benefits. Candidates wrote irrelevant information, such as general office practices or digital filing, which was not aligned with the requirement of question. These responses reflected a lack of understanding of the concept and failure to connect the answer with the scenario presented in the question.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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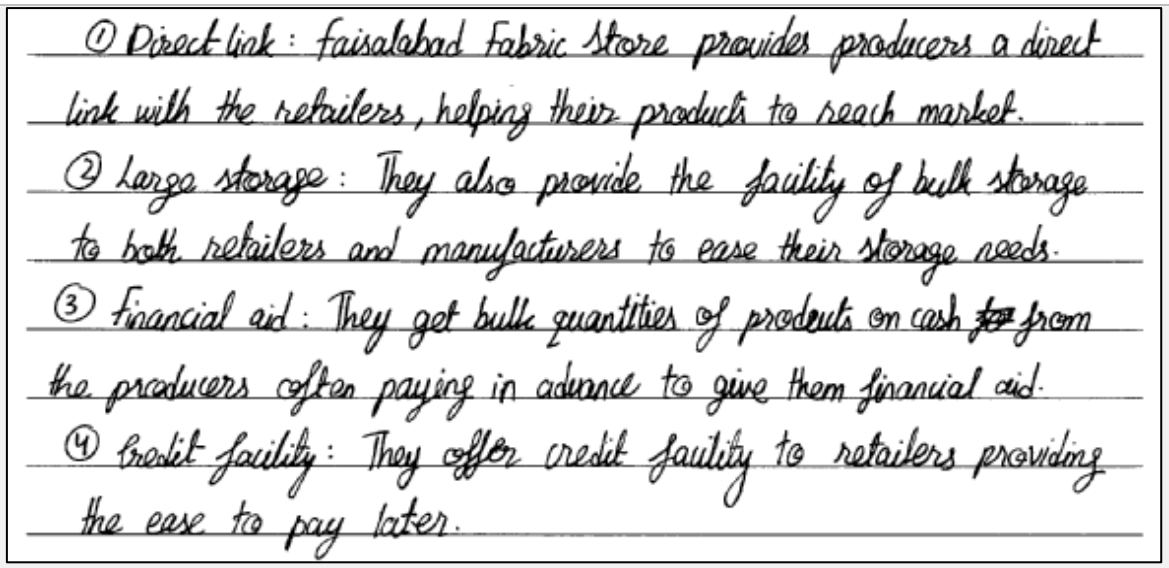
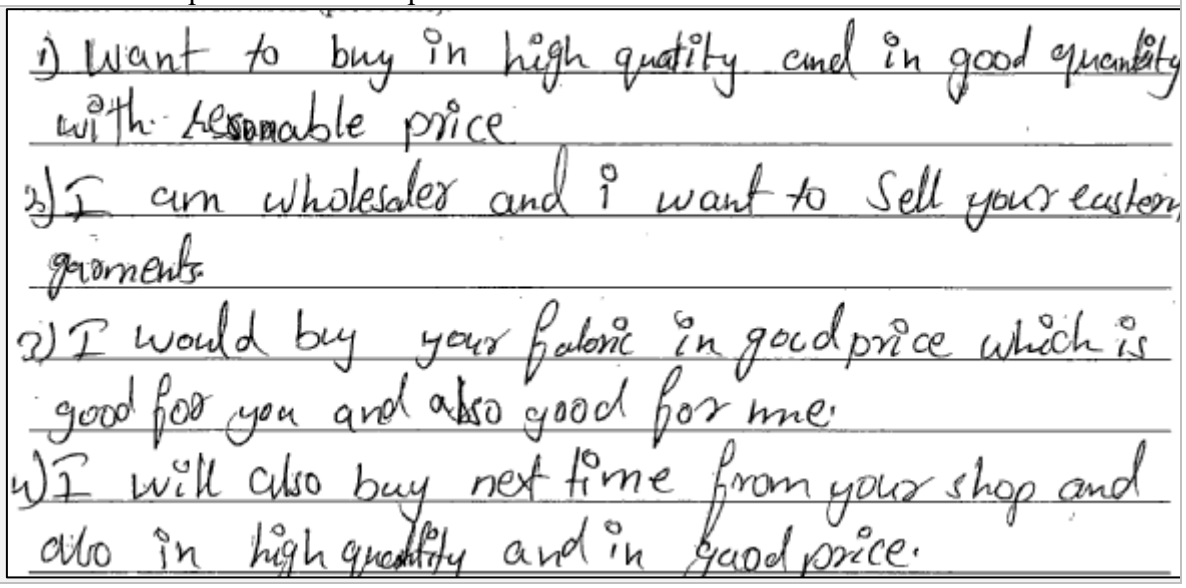
• Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Reinforce the difference between horizontal and vertical filing systems through classroom demonstrations.
- Encourage practice with scenario-based questions where candidates identify the filing system and explain its advantages.
- Provide exercises that link practical office situations to the appropriate filing method.

Question No. 6

Question Text	Faisalabad Fabric Store is a garments wholesaler which mainly deals in all varieties eastern garments for men, women and children. They would like to establish strong relationships with retailers and manufacturers through a set of trade facilitation services. With reference to the trade activity, mention any FOUR basic facilitation they can provide to their retailers or manufacturers (producers).
SLO No.	4.3.6
SLO Text	Describe the services rendered by wholesalers to retailers and producers.
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for listing each service they can render (FOUR required).
Overall Performance	Many candidates performed well in this question, while many others achieved satisfactory marks. The question tested direct knowledge of the services provided by wholesalers, which is a basic yet important concept in trade. Some candidates confused wholesalers with retailers and wrote about retailer services instead. This confusion resulted in the deduction of marks. It required accurate recall of the role and functions of wholesalers. Candidates who were unable to attempt the question indicated that they needed to study the channels of distribution in greater depth to strengthen their grasp of these concepts.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* showed that candidates had a clear understanding of the services rendered by wholesalers to retailers and manufacturers. These candidates correctly identified wholesalers as intermediaries who bridge the gap between producers and retailers. They explained that wholesalers provide storage facilities to producers, which reduces the burden of stock maintenance for them. They also highlighted that wholesalers make advance payments to producers, which improves cash flow for manufacturers, and that wholesalers often extend credit facilities to retailers, enabling them to maintain sales even when immediate funds are not available. In addition, strong answers also mentioned how wholesalers reduce risk for producers by purchasing goods in bulk and ensure regular supply for retailers.

Image of Better Response	
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* lacked clarity and accuracy. Some candidates provided incomplete points that did not fully explain the services of wholesalers. In certain cases, irrelevant information was included, such as writing about invoices or discussing unrelated topics like the role of retailers or producers. This showed that those candidates either misunderstood the question or lacked conceptual understanding of the difference between wholesalers and other market participants. These responses were disorganised, vague, and failed to directly address the requirement of the question.
Image of Weaker Response	

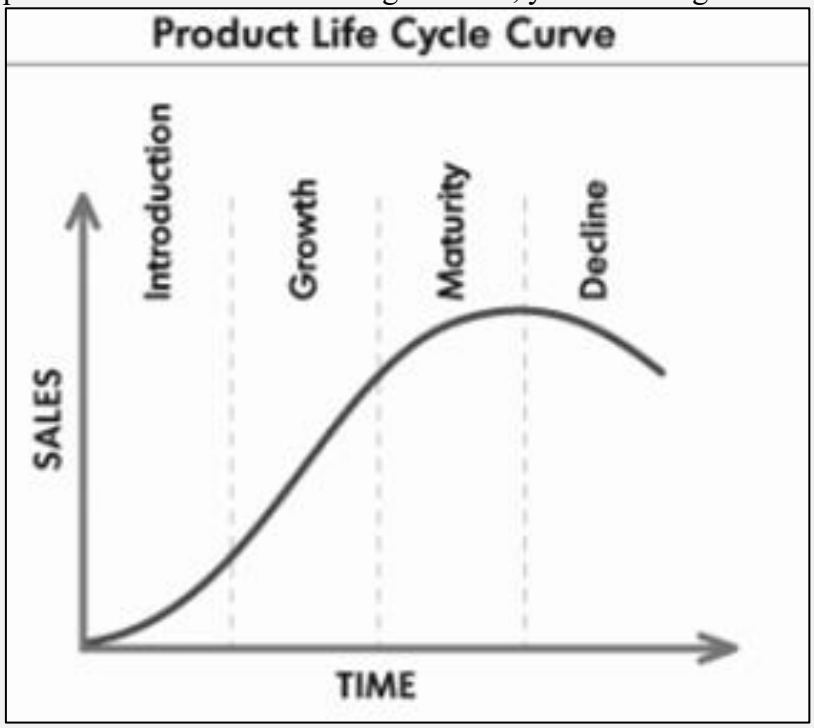
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

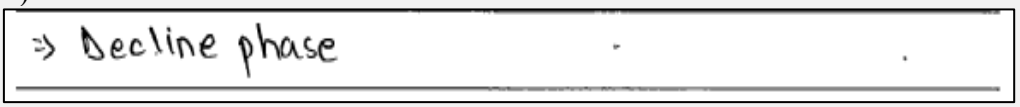
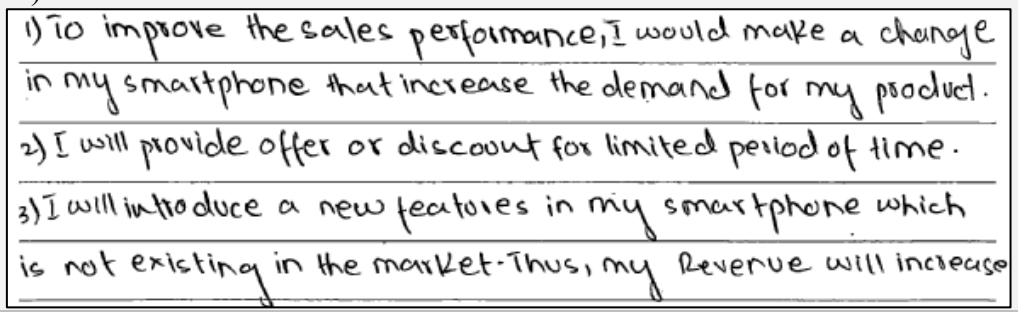
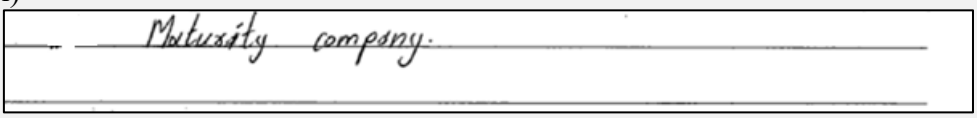
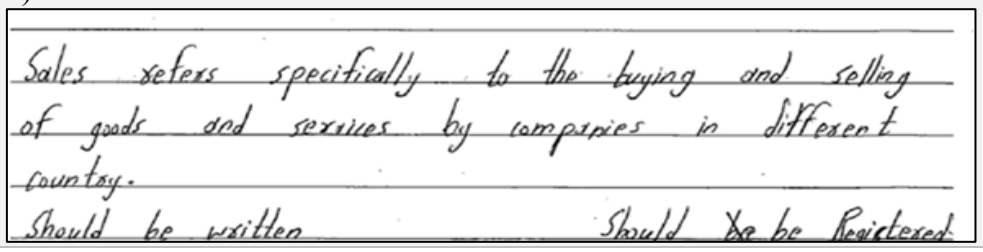
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• Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Practice of past paper questions on wholesalers and trade functions.
- Group discussions guided by e-marking notes to highlight frequent mistakes.
- Short, structured tasks requiring candidates to list and explain wholesaler services.
- Oral questioning and class quizzes to test quick recall.
- Case-based questions using local trade examples to check contextual understanding.

Question No. 7	
Question Text	Imagine you are the product manager of a smartphone company. The company recently launched a new model that initially saw high sales and significant market buzz. However, after a few months, sales started to stabilise, and competitors released similar products with newer technologies. Now, you notice a gradual decline in sales.  i. Based on the given scenario, identify the current stage of the product life cycle of the smartphone in the given graph. ii. Mention any THREE strategies you would implement to extend its market life and improve sales performance.
SLO No.	Draw a product life cycle diagram (taking into account an imaginary product).
SLO Text	5.3.7
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for the identification of product life cycle stage in the given diagram. Gives ONE mark for mentioning the three points or strategies business can opt.

Overall Performance	A good number of the candidates scored 3 or 4 marks in this question, which showed that the majority had a good understanding of the topic. The question was scenario-based, yet most candidates were able to apply their knowledge effectively to the given situation. This reflected both familiarity with the product life cycle and the ability to connect theoretical knowledge with practical examples. A smaller proportion of candidates struggled, mainly because they misidentified the stage of the product life cycle, which reduced the accuracy of their responses. Overall, the performance indicated that candidates were confident with this area of the syllabus and that teaching strategies used for this topic has been effective.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses*, candidates correctly identified the current stage of the product life cycle as the decline stage. They supported their answers with logical reasoning by explaining that the product was losing demand, which is a clear indicator of decline. Furthermore, they clearly mentioned the three extension strategies required in the question. These included introducing new product features to attract customers, changing the existing packaging to create a fresh appeal, and identifying new markets to expand the product's reach. Some candidates also mentioned sales promotions, such as reducing prices or offering discounts, as a valid extension strategy. The answers were well-structured, relevant, and directly addressed the requirements of the question, demonstrating a clear understanding of the topic.
Images of Better Response	i)  ii) 
Description of Weaker Responses	In the *weaker responses*, candidates incorrectly identified the stage of the product life cycle. Instead of recognising it as the decline stage, some candidates mentioned irrelevant stages or avoided giving a clear answer. In addition, several candidates wrote unrelated content, such as details about partnerships, which had no connection to the product life cycle or extension strategies. These responses showed a lack of understanding of the topic and limited knowledge of the key concepts. A small number of candidates scored zero because they provided vague answers or repeated unrelated information without addressing the question.
Images of Weaker Response	i)  ii) 

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion:

- Use real product case studies (e.g., brands that introduce new packaging or features to extend sales).
- Encourage candidates to bring examples from local markets where products faced decline but were revived through promotions or redesign.
- Create classroom activities such as role-play, where candidates act as marketing managers and propose strategies.
- Display charts and diagrams of product life cycle stages on classroom soft boards for constant reinforcement.

Question No. 8	
Question Text	A real estate developer, ABC Builders, approached an Islamic bank for financing a residential project. ABC Builders contributed 60%, while the bank contributed 40% of the total investment. Both parties shared ownership of the project based on their respective contributions. Now when the residential units are sold, the profits generated from the sales are distributed between both the parties according to a pre- agreed ratio. If any losses occur, they are shared proportionately based on each party's initial capital contribution. i. Identify the source of Islamic finance in the given scenario. ii. Mention any THREE strategies you would implement to extend its market life and improve sales performance.
SLO No.	Recommend a suitable mode of Islamic finance that will be adopted by a business under any scenario.
SLO Text	6.5.9
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for correctly identify the Islamic source of finance as *Musharaka*. Give ONE mark for mention profit and loss sharing as a feature of *Musharaka*. Give ONE mark to mention capital contribution as a feature of *Musharaka*.
Overall Performance	Many candidates scored full marks in this question which indicates that question was relatively easy. However, candidates were unable to perform due to their lack of knowledge in Islamic sources of finance
Description of Better Responses	In the *better responses*, candidates demonstrated sound understanding of the concept. They correctly identified *Musharaka* as the Islamic source of finance and explained its features with accuracy. Most of them highlighted that in *Musharaka* both parties

	contribute capital and profits or losses are shared according to an agreed ratio. Some candidates even added examples from business practices to support their answer, showing not only knowledge but also application. These responses were well-structured, precise, and reflected thorough preparation.
Images of Better Response	i) Musharaka ii) Investment is not done by just one party, both parties have invested the capital. If any loss occurs both will share it according to the agreed ratio, only one party will not share the loss.
Description of Weaker Responses	In *weaker responses*, candidates failed to identify the correct source of Islamic finance. Instead, they wrote unrelated terms such as Takaful, Islamic mode, interest-free banking, or other vague phrases. Since they confused the basic requirement of the question, they were unable to state the two features of *Musharaka* correctly. Their answers lacked clarity, conceptual understanding, and relevance. In many cases, the responses appeared to be guessed rather than informed answers.
Images of Weaker Response	i) The Islamic finance bussiness non-profit bussiness are edhi & chippa JDC ~~are~~ are non-profit bussiness in Islamic country the basic basic need is to run bussiness for neded peoples. ii) The Islamic finance The ~~donate~~ donate are donate the money For needed people the to live a life so the builder build a building and bank are held to contribution. for needed people stay good life.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Practice past paper questions related to Islamic finance to build accuracy and avoid confusion among different terms.

Question No.9

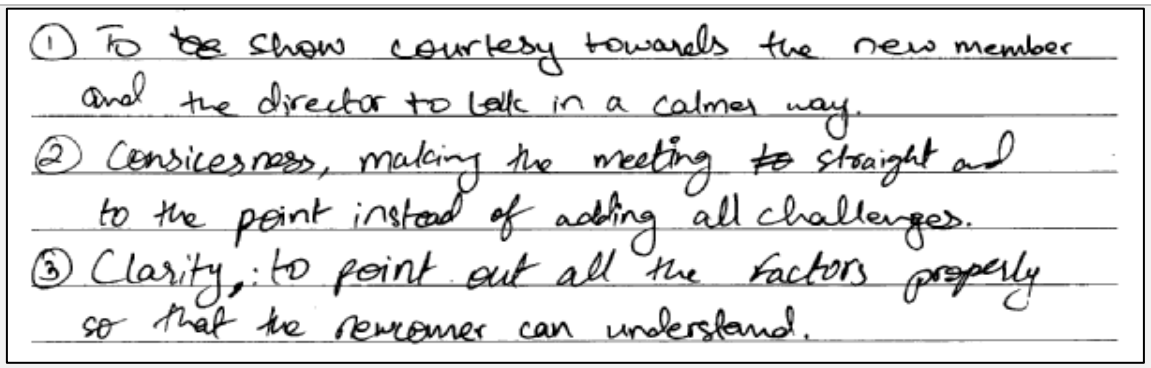
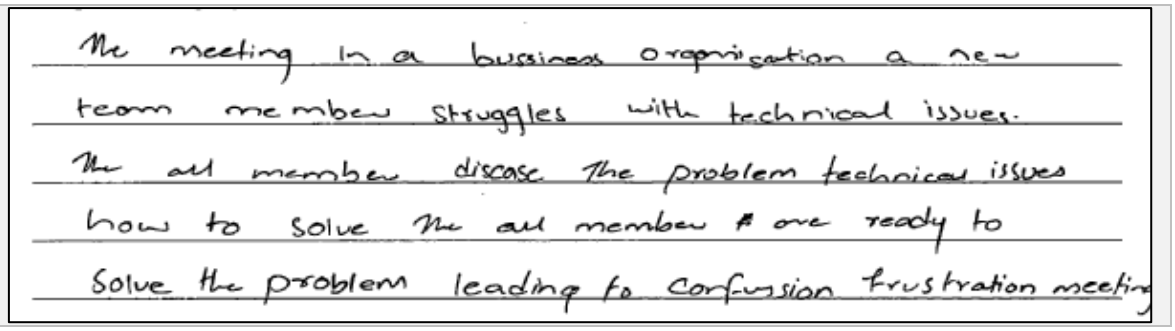
Question Text	During an instant virtual meeting in a business organisation, a new team member struggles with technical issues. In addition, the meeting was highly dominated by the director, talking authoritatively about multiple challenges of the company. As the meeting started abruptly, the new team member faced difficulty understanding the technical jargon, leading to confusion, demotivation and frustration. Suggest any THREE strategies to overcome communication barriers in the given virtual meeting.
SLO No.	7.5.7
SLO Text	Suggest different ways to overcome communication barriers in business communication.
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each suggestion (THREE required).
Overall Performance	Only a few candidates managed to score full marks on this question. Most answers focused on general technical issues of virtual meetings rather than applying the 7Cs of communication to the scenario. Many candidates overlooked the question stem and did not relate their points to the barriers faced by the new team member.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* showed that candidates had clearly understood the requirement of the question and were able to apply the 7Cs of communication directly to the scenario. Instead of listing all the principles, they selected the most relevant ones and explained how these could address the barriers faced during the meeting. For instance, candidates highlighted the importance of clarity by suggesting that the meeting should begin with a clear agenda and simple explanations rather than complex technical jargon. They also pointed out the need for conciseness, recommending that the director avoid lengthy discussions and allow more space for interaction and participation. In addition, candidates emphasised courtesy and consideration, stressing that respectful communication and acknowledgment of the new member's challenges would reduce frustration and help build confidence.
Image of Better Response	 ① To be show courtesy towards the new member and the director to talk in a calmer way. ② Consiceness, making the meeting ~~to~~ straight and to the point instead of adding all challenges. ③ Clarity, : to point out all the factors properly so that the newcomer can understand.
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* revealed that candidates struggled to apply the 7Cs to the situation. Many focused on irrelevant technical issues such as poor internet connection, microphone problems, or switching to another application, which did not meet the question's demand. Others simply listed all the 7Cs without applying them to the scenario, which restricted the marks they could achieve. These responses reflected weak conceptual clarity and insufficient practice in applying knowledge to case-based questions.

Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	**Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO**	**Assessment Strategies**
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: • Emphasis the need to practice application-based questions from past papers to build confidence in applying concepts.		

Extended Response Questions (ERQs)
Choice of Either/ OR
Question No. 10a

Question Text	Sarah, a talented baker, is planning to open her own bakery. She can start the business as a sole proprietor or partner with her friend, Erum. She is also an experienced baker and has offered her additional capital and baking skills. Sarah is concerned about managing the financial risks and workload on her own but she is worried about sharing decision-making power and profits in partnership. Based on this scenario, evaluate any THREE factors Sarah should consider in taking the decision.
SLO No.	2.5.3
SLO Text	Evaluate the factors that influence an entrepreneur in selection of the form of business i.e. sole proprietor or partnership.
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning the factor (THREE required). Give ONE mark for connecting the factors to the scenario. Give ONE mark for evaluating each mentioned factor.
Overall Performance	Majority of the student opted for this question. However, the performance was not up to the mark. Due to a lack of understanding of the command words, candidates generally wrote the characteristics, advantages, or disadvantages of sole proprietorship and partnership instead of evaluating each point as required. This shows that many candidates failed to differentiate between a descriptive and an evaluative response. A stronger grasp of the command word "evaluate" is needed to attempt such questions effectively.
Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* demonstrated a clear understanding of the task. Candidates identified the determinants for selecting a particular form of business such as size of capital, degree of control, risk-bearing capacity, liability, and growth prospects. Importantly, they did not stop at listing these factors but evaluated each point in the context of why a sole proprietorship or partnership might be chosen. For example, they explained that sole proprietorship allows greater control but has limited access to capital, whereas partnership improves capital availability but requires sharing of profits and decision-making. Such answers were comprehensive, analytical, and directly addressed the command word.

Images of Better Response

Three factors Sarah should consider in taking the decision are:

1) Decision Making:-

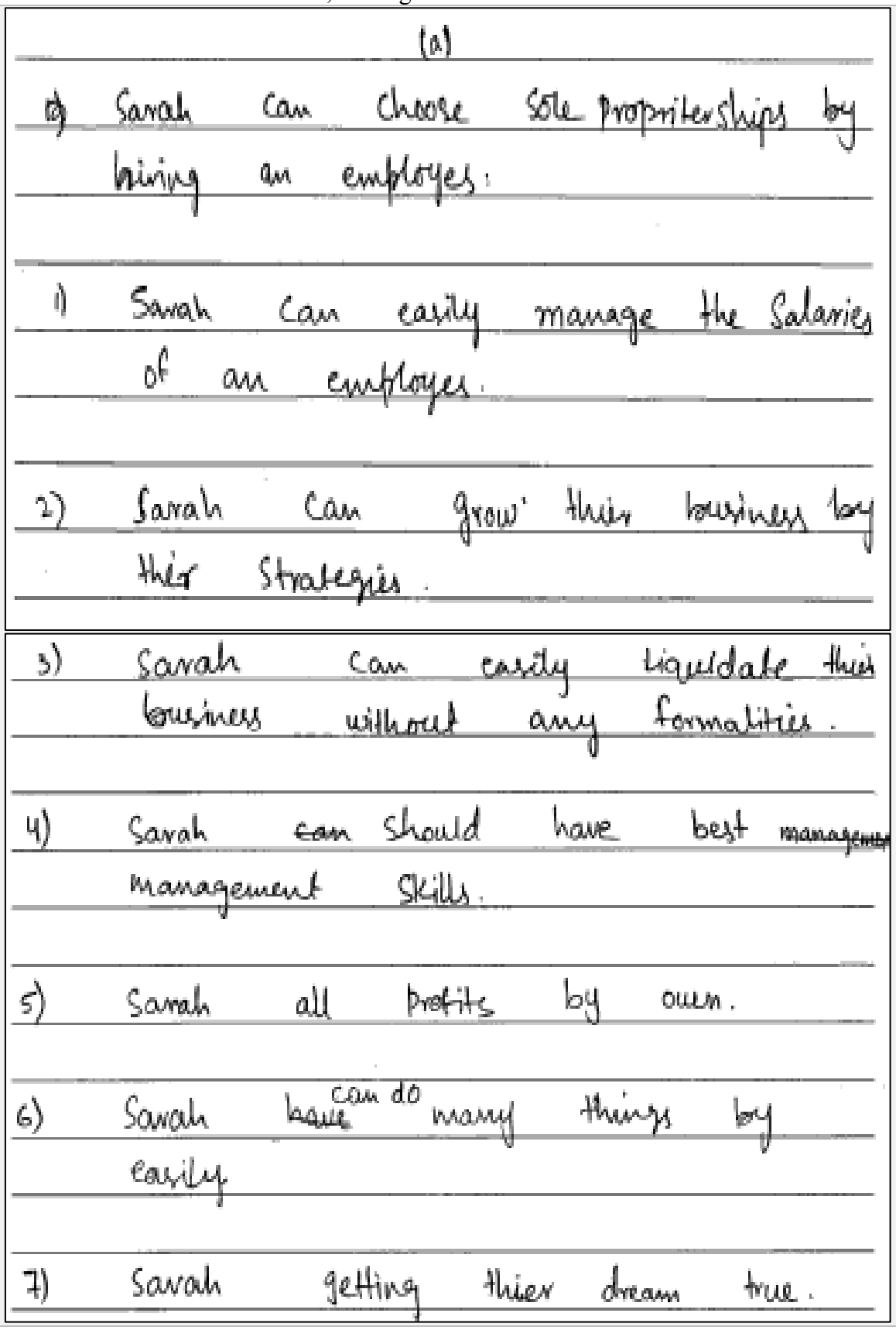
The decisions in sole trading business will be made solely by Sarah but in partnership the decision making will be done by both on mutual understanding. The decision making is sole proprietorship is quick and efficient whereas in partnership decision can cause delays due to difference of opinion. Sara and Erum may start having conflicts and disputes regarding business decisions aswell but in sole no conflicts are caused Sara can take her business decision on her own without anyones opinion.

2) Profit Sharing:-

In sole profit generated belong to the sole owner as in sole it is a effort reward relationship. In sole all the profit will be of sara but in partnership sara would have to share profits with erum as she has invested in the business aswell and she has a legal right to claim profits regardless of the efforts made. Even if sara will work more and put efforts she will get the share in profits.

3) Capital:-

In sole trading business as sara is the only member/ owner she will have less amount of capital to run the business whereas in partnership & Erum would also ~~put~~ invest her capital in the business aswell leading to High capital investment in the business. High capital in the business would lead to expansion of business.

Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* lacked depth and failed to focus on the actual requirement of the question. Instead of discussing determinants with evaluation, candidates merely wrote down the general characteristics of a sole proprietorship such as "easy to form" or "owner enjoys all profits." Some even listed advantages and disadvantages of partnership without linking them to the decision-making process. These answers were descriptive in nature and did not reflect critical evaluation, leading to lower marks.
Images of Weaker Response	

(a)

a) Sarah can choose Sole proprietorships by hiring an employes.

1) Sarah can easily manage the Salaries of an employes.

2) Sarah can grow' their bowiness by their Strategies.

3) Sarah can easily liquidate their bowiness without any formalities.

4) Sarah can should have best management management Skills.

5) Sarah all profits by own.

6) Sarah have can do many things by easily

7) Sarah getting thier dream true.

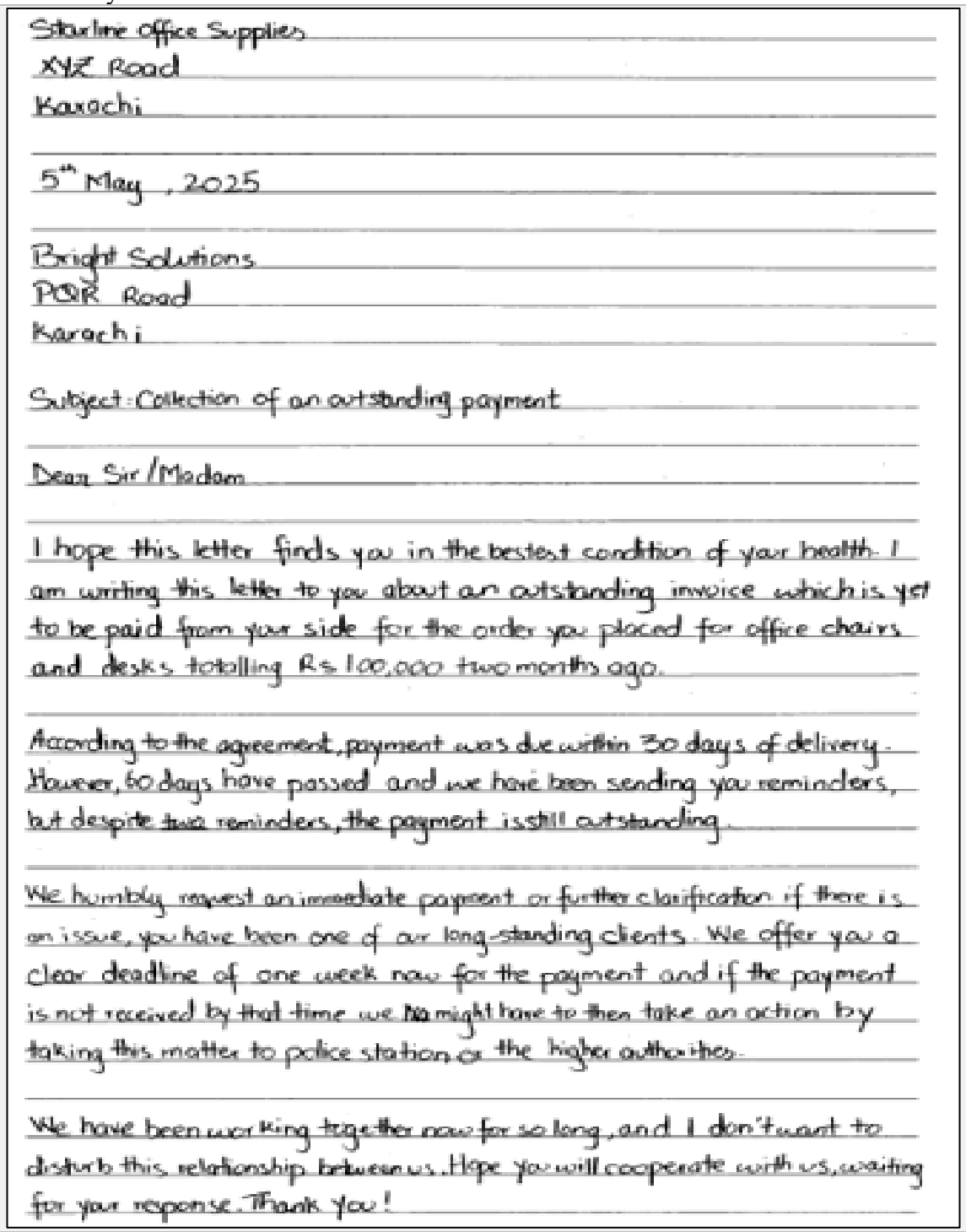
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

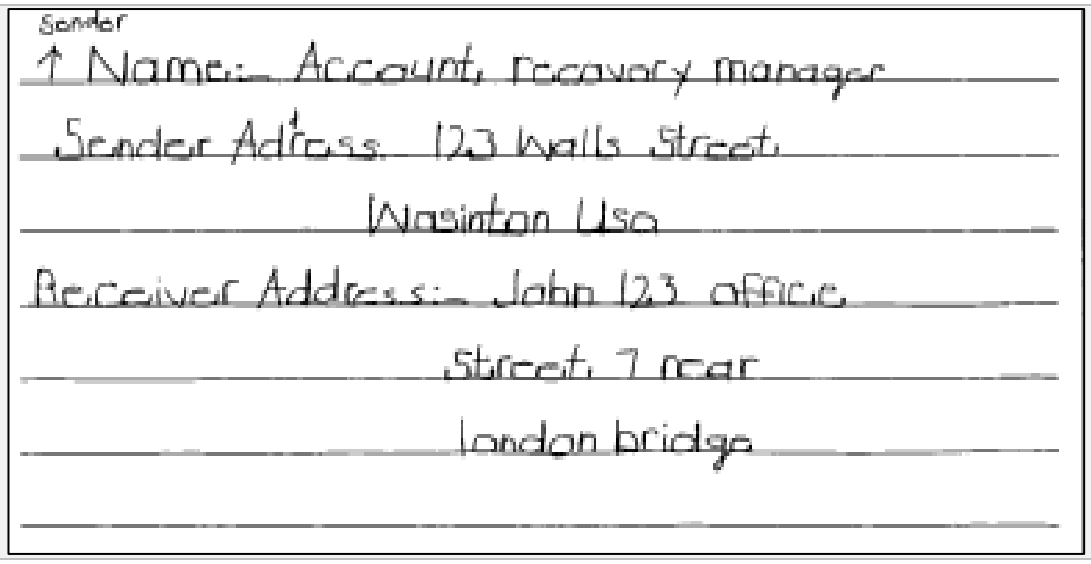
Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes

Any Additional Suggestion:

- Practice command words: Teachers should emphasis the meanings of common command words (evaluate, analyse, compare, distinguish, etc.) and practice them in classroom discussions.

Question No. 10b	
Question Text	You are an 'account recovery manager' at 'Starline Office Supplies, a company that supplies office furniture and equipment to various businesses. One of your long-standing clients, Bright Solutions', placed an order for office chairs and desks totalling Rs 100,000 two months ago. According to the agreement, payment was due within 30 days of delivery. However, 60 days have passed, and despite two reminders, the payment is still outstanding. Write a formal collection/ dunning letter to 'Bright Solutions', urging them to settle the overdue amount while maintaining a professional tone to preserve the business relationship. Your letter should: • Refer to the outstanding invoice • Mention previous reminders • Request immediate payment or further clarification if there is an issue • Offer a clear deadline for the payment • Mention any potential actions if payment isn't received by that time.
SLO No.	7.4.9
SLO Text	Draft 'collection letter' with the necessary details.
Max Marks	7
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for an introductory para or start. Give ONE mark for proper referencing and salutation. Give FOUR marks for mentioning each of major points in the body bullet in the question scenario. Give ONE mark for closer and ending.
Overall Performance	Though this question was opted by a small number of students. Out of the students who opted for it majority were able to secure full marks. This is generally considered a scoring question as the required format is straightforward and familiar to most candidates. A few lost marks, and those who did so were primarily due to ignoring the proper structure of a formal letter. The overall performance in this part was satisfactory and reflected that most candidates had practiced letter writing beforehand.

Description of Better Responses	The *better responses* demonstrated a clear understanding of the expected structure of a formal letter. The candidates included all essential elements such as a proper heading, inside address, subject line, salutation, body paragraphs, and appropriate closing. The language used was formal and relevant to the context of the letter. The sequence and organisation of the content were logical, making the letter easy to follow and well-presented. These responses showed that the candidates not only understood the format but also maintained clarity and relevance in their writing, which fulfilled the requirement of the question effectively.
Image of Better Response	 Starline Office Supplies XYZ Road Karachi 5th May, 2025 Bright Solutions PQR Road Karachi Subject: Collection of an outstanding payment Dear Sir/Madam I hope this letter finds you in the bestest condition of your health. I am writing this letter to you about an outstanding invoice which is yet to be paid from your side for the order you placed for office chairs and desks totalling Rs. 100,000 two months ago. According to the agreement, payment was due within 30 days of delivery. However, 60 days have passed and we have been sending you reminders, but despite two reminders, the payment is still outstanding. We humbly request an immediate payment or further clarification if there is an issue, you have been one of our long-standing clients. We offer you a clear deadline of one week now for the payment and if the payment is not received by that time we might have to then take an action by taking this matter to police station or the higher authorities. We have been working together now for so long, and I don't want to disturb this relationship between us. Hope you will cooperate with us, waiting for your response. Thank you!
Description of Weaker Responses	The *weaker responses* revealed a lack of understanding of the formal letter format. Some candidates mistakenly used the email format, while others omitted critical elements such as the address, subject, and proper salutation. The body of the letter was often either too brief or irrelevant to the question, and the closing was missing or inappropriate. These issues indicated insufficient practice and confusion between different formats of written

	communication. Such responses failed to meet the expectations of the question and therefore resulted in the loss of marks.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review of past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes
Any Additional Suggestion: • Practice writing letters by attempting past paper questions to build confidence and accuracy.		

Annexure A: Pedagogies Used for Teaching the SLOs

Pedagogy: Storyboard
Description: A visual pedagogy that uses a series of illustrated panels to present a narrative, encouraging creativity and critical thinking. It helps learners organise ideas, sequence events, and comprehend complex concepts through storytelling.
Example: In a Literature class, students are tasked with creating storyboards to visually retell a novel. They draw key scenes, write captions, and present their stories to the class, enhancing their reading comprehension and fostering their imagination.

Pedagogy: Cause and Effect
Description: This pedagogy explores the relationships between actions and consequences. By analysing cause-and-effect relationships, learners develop a deeper understanding of how events are interconnected and how one action can lead to various outcomes.
Example: In a History class, students study the causes and effects of the Industrial Revolution. They research and discuss how technological advancements in manufacturing led to significant societal changes, such as urbanisation and labour reform movements.

Pedagogy: Fish and Bone
Description: A method that breaks down complex topics into main ideas (the fish) and supporting details (the bones). This visual approach enhances comprehension by highlighting essential concepts and their relevant explanations.
Example: During a Biology class on human anatomy, the teacher uses the fish and bone technique to teach about the human skeletal system. Teacher presents the main components of the human skeleton (fish) and elaborates on each bone's structure and function (bones).

Pedagogy: Concept Mapping
Description: An effective way to visually represent relationships between ideas. Learners create diagrams connecting key concepts, aiding in understanding the overall structure of a subject and fostering retention.
Example: In a Psychology assignment, students use concept mapping to explore the various theories of personality. They interlink different theories, such as Freud's psychoanalysis, Jung's analytical psychology, and Bandura's social-cognitive theory, to see how they relate to each other.

Pedagogy: Audio Visual Resources
Description: Incorporating multimedia elements like videos, images, and audio into lessons. This approach caters to different learning styles, making educational content more engaging and memorable.
Example: In a General Science class, the teacher uses a documentary-style video to teach about the solar system. The video includes stunning visual animations of the planets, interviews with astronomers, and background music, enhancing students' interest and understanding of space.

Pedagogy: Think, Pair, and Share
Description: A collaborative learning technique where students ponder a question or problem individually, then discuss their thoughts in pairs or small groups before sharing with the entire class. It fosters active participation, communication skills, and diverse perspectives.
Example: In a Literature in English class, the teacher poses a thought-provoking question about a novel's moral dilemma. Students first reflect individually, then pair up to exchange their opinions, and finally participate in a lively class discussion to explore different viewpoints.

Pedagogy: Questioning Technique (Socratic Approach)
Description: Based on Socratic dialogue, this method stimulates critical thinking by posing thought-provoking questions. It encourages learners to explore ideas, justify their reasoning, and discover knowledge through a process of inquiry.
Example: In an Ethics class, the instructor uses the Socratic approach to lead a discussion on the meaning of justice. By asking a series of probing questions, the students engage in a deeper exploration of ethical principles and societal values.

Pedagogy: Practical Demonstration
Description: A hands-on approach where learners observe real-life applications of theories or skills. Practical demonstrations enhance comprehension, skill acquisition, and problem-solving abilities by bridging theoretical concepts with real-world scenarios.
Example: In a Food and Nutrition class, the instructor demonstrates the proper technique for filleting a fish. Students observe and then practice the skill themselves, learning the practical application of knife skills and culinary precision.

(**Note:** The examples provided in this annexure serve as illustrations of various pedagogies. It is important to understand that these pedagogies are versatile and can be applied across subjects in numerous ways. Feel free to adapt and explore these techniques creatively to enhance learning outcomes in your specific context.)

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• Dr Naveed Yousuf, CEO, AKU-EB